

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

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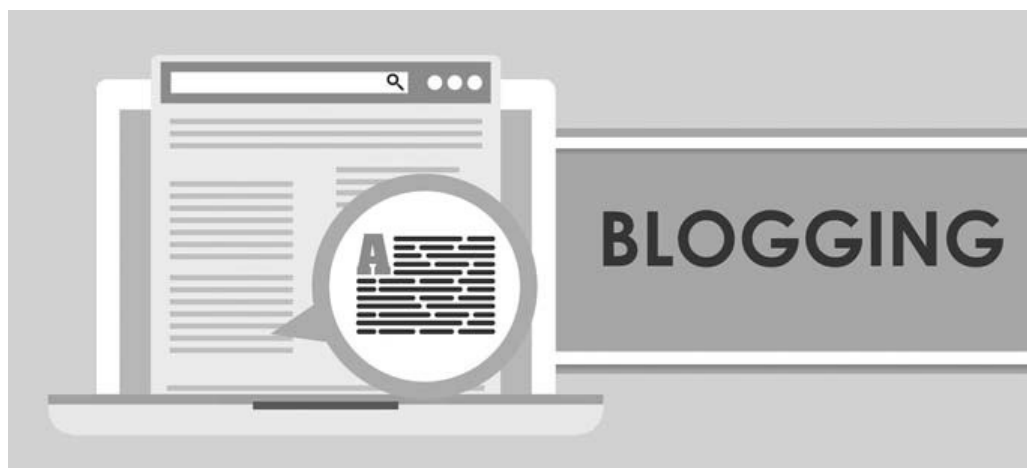
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Kristi offers grammar tips to BFP's online community.



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read company blogs? Which companies do you follow?
- If you were asked to write a blog related to work, what would you write about?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about the present results of something in the past, related to job and work situations.
- I can write about the purpose of events or actions.
- I can write a blog post.

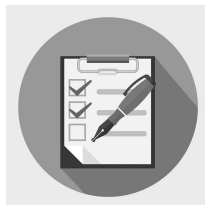




Let's Explore!

Kristi is asked to write about a topic related to her job. Working in the publishing industry, she finds common writing errors are a **hot topic***

* A "hot topic" is a topic that is often talked about.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Good Writing Equals Good Grammar

Writers always strive to write in a concise way with perfect grammar. Yet, there are times when even the best of writers are stumped when it comes to some grammar rules. Since these common mistakes are often made, editors and proofreaders are then left to decipher a writer's intentions.

Let's investigate some elusive "head scratchers".

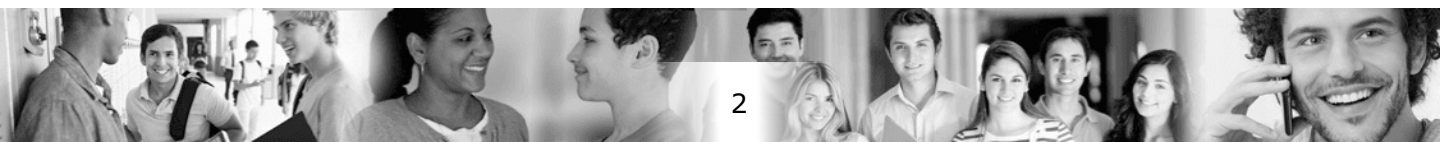
Affect and *effect* are a common source of confusion. In most cases, *affect* is a verb, as in: "She was negatively affected by the schedule ", whereas *effect* is a noun, as in: "The effect of the schedule on the rest of the team was minimal." *Affect* is used for describing an action while *effect* is used for addressing an event.

Sometimes the words *borrow* and *lend* are confusing since they are often used interchangeably. To *borrow* something means to take something with the intention of giving that object back. To *lend* something is to give something, expecting that the object be returned. Consider these two examples: "Can I borrow your office for a minute so that we can have our scheduled meeting?" and "Can you lend me a pen in case I need one?" There are significant differences between *few* and *less*. To begin, *fewer* is used when discussing countable nouns, and *less* is used when describing the intangible. Look at these examples: "I need to drink fewer cups of coffee at work in order to sleep better". "It seems like I have less time to see my friends nowadays."

Since the beginning of written language, the words *lay* and *lie* have been a source of frustration and bewilderment.

To begin with, it's important to recognize that *lay* and *lie* are both verbs in the present tense. *Lie* means "to rest" (or "to not tell the truth"), while *lay* means "to put or place". Look at these examples: "Did you lay the book down on the sofa?" "I'm going to lie down for about an hour."

Using perfect grammar can be rather tedious. Yet, it's extremely important that budding writers master these common mistakes. Fewer errors means a more promising career with greater financial rewards. So, take note of these four common grammar errors and check back in the coming weeks for more helpful suggestions!





Let's Practice!

Let's write about what people do at work.

Instructions: Use a connector from the Word Bank to continue with the sentence. Complete the sentence with your own ideas. Compare your sentences with your partner's.

Word Bank

in order to / in case / so that

1. Can I borrow your office for a minute _____.
2. Can you lend me a pen _____.
3. I need to drink fewer cups of coffee _____.



Let's Practice!

Imagine you are asked to write a blog about a work related topic. What would you write about?

Instructions:

- Write a 150-180-word blog about a topic related to the publishing industry. Proofread your blog for grammar, spelling and punctuation errors.
- Include a title.
- Use language appropriate to the company's goals and objectives. For example, a publishing company wouldn't use slang.
- Write a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence.
- Include a sentence that suggests that the reader become a regular follower.





Extension Activity

You are now the social media specialist for your company. The CEO asks you to write a blog on a topic of your choice.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 150-180-word blog on a work related topic of your choice.
- Your blog can be related to skills, education or professional relationships. Examples: teamwork, dealing with difficult customers, issues with co-workers, time management.
- Draw the reader's attention and finish the blog by suggesting that readers should read the blog on a regular basis.
- Proofread the blog and then read it to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a blog about a work related topic.

☐ ☐

I draw the reader's attention in a blog.

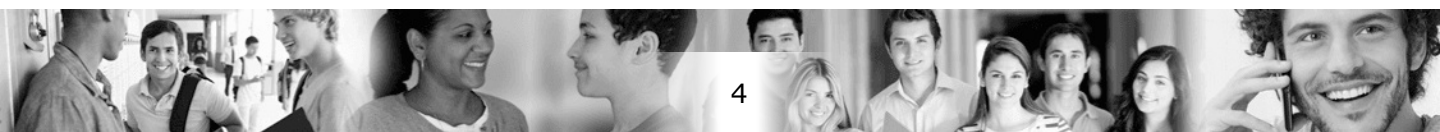
☐ ☐

I complete the blog by suggesting that the reader become a regular subscriber.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- concise** (adjective): not including extra or unnecessary information
e.g. Writers always strive to write in a concise way with perfect grammar.
- to decipher** (verb): to find the meaning of something that is difficult to read or understand
e.g. Since common mistakes are often made, editors and proofreaders are left to decipher a writer's intentions.
- to stump** (verb): to be too difficult for someone to answer
e.g. Yet, there are times when even the best of writers are stumped when it comes to grammar rules.
- intention** (noun): the thing that you plan to do or achieve
e.g. To *borrow* something means to take something with the intention of giving that object back.
- intangible** (noun): something not made of physical substance; not able to be touched
e.g. To begin, *fewer* is used when discussing countable, and *less* is used when describing the intangible.
- tedious** (adjective): boring and too slow or long
e.g. Using perfect grammar can be rather tedious.
- head scratcher** (expression): something confusing or puzzling
e.g. Let's investigate some elusive "head scratchers".





Learning Points

Commenting on Results: The Present Perfect

You can use the **Present Perfect** tense to comment on past events that have a present result.

You use the words **since** and **yet** to stress the connection between past and present. When you are talking about an action starting in the past and continuing up to now, you can use have/has + past participle with **since** + a specific time in the past.

Yet means that something that we expected has happened or hasn't happened.

For example:

*There was no news this morning, but **we've since learned** that the company will fold.*

*I **haven't met anyone yet** who can pitch a sale like he can.*

Examples:

- *Yet, there are times when even the best of writers have been stumped by grammar rules.*
- *Since the writers have often made mistakes, it's up to the editors and proofreaders to find them.*





Learning Points

Clauses

You can use **for** to talk about somebody's purpose for doing something, but only when it is followed by a noun.

For example:

*We stopped into the boardroom **for a brief meeting**.*

You can use **for** with the *-ing* form of a verb to express the purpose of a thing - what it is used for.

For example:

*A smartboard is used **for projecting** digital documents.*

You can introduce result clauses using:

so and *so ... that*

For example:

*The three of us were very busy **so we decided to hire more salespeople**.*

You can introduce reason clauses using:

in case

For example:

*Bring an umbrella **in case it rains again**.*

Examples:

- *Affect is used for describing an action while effect is used for addressing an event.*
- *Can I borrow your office for a minute so that we can have our scheduled meeting?*
- *Can you lend me a pen in case I need one?*

